Player Count: 2-6
Type: Indian Heritage

Time: 40 minutes
Complexity: High

Rahee – A Traveller's Journey Across India

The Idea

Rahee ("traveller") is a game about characters making the richest journey across India. Your hand of playing cards is your itinerary: play it wisely for the best journey. Maximize travel experience by reaching your character's destination goals, visiting tourist places, and collecting sets of memories – all while staying within your travel budget.

What You Need

The game board, one deck of regular playing cards, pen and paper for scoring, and some coloured tokens (small buttons work well). You need a minimum of two tokens per player: one for the board and one for your character card. Memories and tourist visits can be written down or marked using tokens based on the group's preference.

Set Up

1. **Budget**. Give every player a starting budget of ₹25,000. Money left over does not score but overspending is penalised. Spending is tracked on paper.
2. **Choose the first player**. The player who recently traveled furthest starts. Turns will pass clockwise from the first player. For character selection, go the other way: starting with the player to the first player's right and proceeding anticlockwise, each player chooses a character placing a token on the space (see Fig 1).
3. **Place your traveller**. Character cards show a starting city and a list of destination goals. Place a token on the map at the starting city of your chosen character (see Fig 2).



Fig. 1: The characters show a starting city and target destinations.

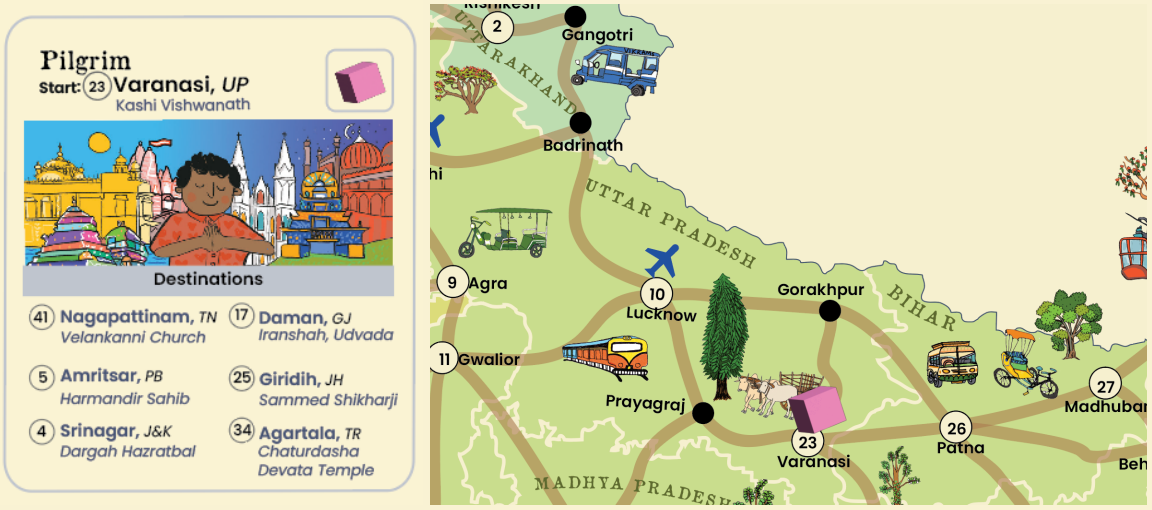


Fig. 2: Place tokens on the chosen characters and starting cities.



Fig. 3: A three player game about to start

Dealing Cards

Build the deck for your player count. Remove 7s, 8s and 9s. For 2-4 players use the Aces, 2s-6s and 10s of all four suits. For 5-6 players also add the face cards. Queens and Kings have a movement value of 5; Jacks a movement value of 10.

Deal Hand. Give each player one 10 (or J for 5–6 players). Then shuffle the remaining cards and deal the number shown in Table 1 to make the player's starting hand. Set all unused cards aside. No more cards will be drawn once play begins.

Lay your first road-trip card. Place one card from the ones you were dealt face-up in front of you as a road-trip card. Keep the rest of your hand hidden (Fig. 3 shows a game setup).

Players	Cards used	Cards Dealt
2–4	A–6 and 10 of all four suits for a total of 28 cards	6 per player + one 10
5	Add in J (value 10), Q (value 5) and K (value 5) of all four suits for a total of 40 cards	6 per player + one J/10
6		5 per player + one J/10

Table 1: Set-Up Summary

Playing the Game

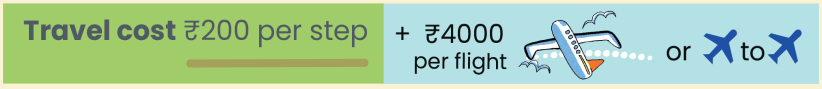
Your starting hand decides your entire journey — nothing is ever drawn or replaced after the set up. The steps below are summarized here and detailed in the sections that follow.

On your turn you play a card and then

1. **Move.** Play a card, move up to its value & pay travel costs.
2. **Note memories and tourism.** Place tokens or write down memories and the tourist visit at the city you ended movement on. Tourism has a cost and is optional. Memories are free.
3. **Offer a road trip.** If you end your movement on a city with other players, you may invite them to travel with you.
4. **End your turn.** Lay the card (or cards) you played this turn face-up in front of you. Such cards accumulate over the game and can later be used for a road trip.

Movement

Play one card (maybe with an Ace). Move your token, at least 1 step and up to the card's movement value, along connected routes. A flight between two airports on the mainland or marked flights to the island count as a step. Pay ₹200 for each step you travel. Add a surcharge for flights (₹4000) or the Kochi-Kavaratti ship (₹1000) on top of step cost.



Creating Memories

You create memories of the played card's suit; each represents a kind: shopping at a Bazaar(♠), eating new Food(♥), hearing a Language(♣), celebrating a Festival(♦). You may create more than one memory in a single turn. Here's how:

1. **Efficient travel**. If you move exactly the full value of the card you played, gain one memory of that card's suit.
2. **Meeting a traveller**. If you finish your movement in a city where another player already is, you gain one memory of the played card's suit.
3. **Road trip**. When players travel together (see below), each traveller gains one memory of the road-trip card's suit.



Fig. 4: Green plays 3♣, moves two steps to Blue and makes a memory.



Fig. 5: Green plays the 2♦ moving exactly two steps to Blue's city. She now gains two memories: for efficient travel & ending with Blue.

Visiting Tourist Places

The numbered cities are tourist places. When you finish your movement on one, you may pay ₹2000 to visit it, mark that tourist-place stamp with one of your tokens. Each tourist place scores only once per player.

A simple turn

It is Green's turn. She is at Jaipur and plays the 5♣.

1. **Move**. 5 steps to Gwalior paying 5 x ₹200 = ₹1,000.
2. **Memories**. Her efficient travel earns one Language(♣) memory.
3. **Tourism**. Green puts a token on Gwalior's stamp & pays ₹2,000.
4. **End**. The 5♣ is placed face-up on the table in front of Green.

Turn cost: ₹3,000, for one memory and one tourist visit.

Road Trips

Invite. If you end your movement in a city with other players, you may invite them on a road trip. Flip a participating player's face-up road-trip card, turn it face-down.

Travel together. The active player proposes a route; the travellers may negotiate the direction. Move all tokens together, at least one step and up to the card's value. Players may choose to travel part of the way.

Pay. You pay the normal travel costs while each companion pays their own flight and ferry surcharges. Additionally, they pay you ₹100 per step they travel with you, offsetting your cost.

Memories. Each player travelling together gains one memory of the road-trip card's suit. If the group moves exactly the card's full value, the active player gains one additional memory of that suit for efficient travel.

Shared tourism. If the trip ends in a tourist place, each traveller may visit it for ₹1000 instead of ₹2000.

Getting dropped off. A companion may leave the trip partway along the route. They pay ₹100 for each step they actually travelled, but forgo the shared-tourism discount.

An example of a turn with a road trip

Green ends her movement with Blue who agrees to a road trip.

1. **Choose a road-trip card.** Green turns the 4♦ in front of Blue face-down. They can move up to 4 steps together.
2. **Travel.** Green and Blue tokens move 4 steps to Bhopal.
3. **Pay.** Green pays 4 × ₹200 = ₹800. Blue pays Green 4 × ₹100 = ₹400. Green writes down her net cost of ₹400.
4. **Memories.** Green gets two Festival(♦) memories: one for the road-trip and one for efficiency. Blue gets one.
5. **Shared Cost.** Each pays ₹1,000 (not ₹2,000). They each mark the Bhopal card with a token of their colour.
6. **Drop-offs.** Had Blue asked to be dropped off partway, he would pay ₹100 per step with no shared-tourism discount.

At most **one road trip** per turn. If it ends in a city with a player who wasn't on the trip, everyone there makes a memory.

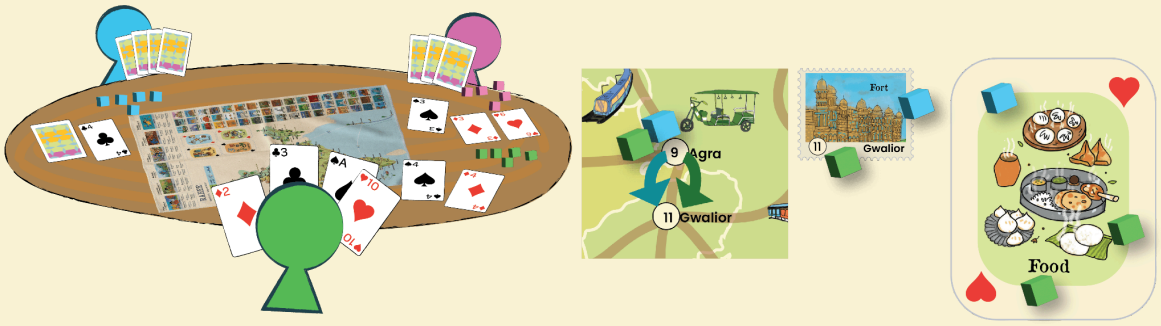


Fig. 6: Green flips the A♥ in front of Blue and they move 1 step.

Playing Aces

An Ace adds flexibility. Play it in one of three ways:

1. **Alone** – move one step.
2. **As a booster** – play it with another card to add one to that card's movement value. ("Full value" for efficient travel then includes the +1.)
3. **For a memory** – play it with another card to create one extra memory of either card's suit (your choice).

If you start with two or more aces, you may discard one from the game and draw a replacement card from the deck, if there are cards left. If not, you may request a reshuffle.

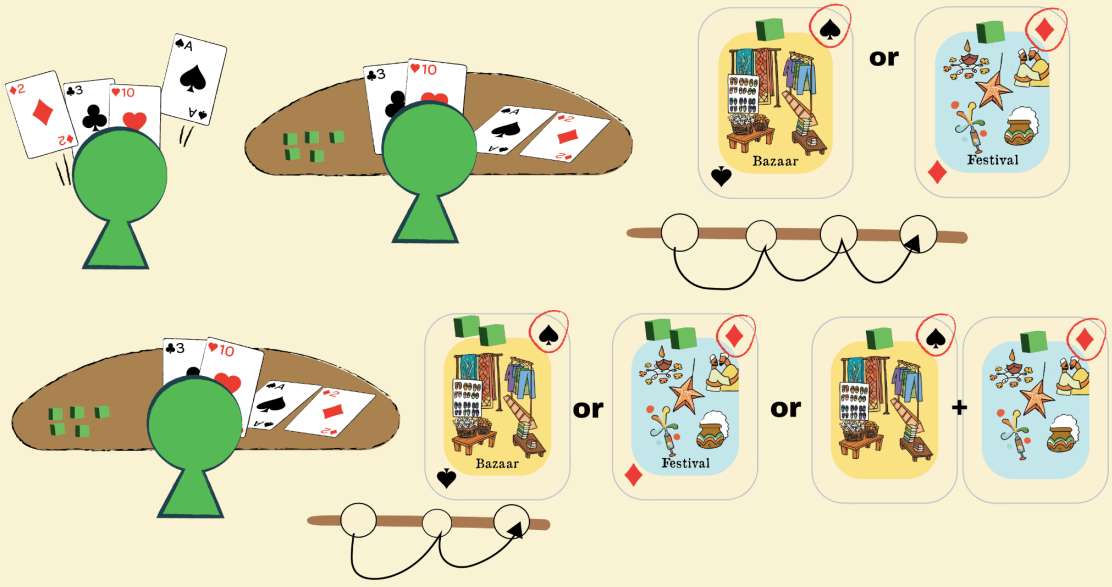


Fig. 7: Green plays 2♦ and A♠. She may either move i) 3 steps, making 2 memories or ii) move up to 2 steps taking 2 memories.

Ending the Game

The end is triggered as soon as any player either plays the last card from their hand, or reaches five of the destination goals on their character card. Finish the current round so that every player has taken the same number of turns, then score by adding up experience points. Any player who completes 5 goals is eligible for the bonus.

Scoring

1. **10 points** for each tourist place you visited.
2. **5 points** for each of your character's destinations visited.
3. **10 points** for players who reach 5 of their destinations.
4. **15 points** for each set of three memories of the same suit.
5. **20 points** for each set of four memories, one of every suit.

Scoring Memory Sets: A single memory can be used in a one same-suit set and a four-suit set. For example, 3 Bazaar memories plus 1 Festival, 1 Language and 1 Food score 35 points (for the Bazaar set and the four-suit set).

Budget: If you spend more than ₹25,000, lose 5 points for every ₹500, or part of ₹500, over budget.